MatchLens

TACTICAL REPORT

Hilltop vs Wokingham Town

Combined Counties Prem North · 31 July 2026 · Silver Jubilee Park · Hilltop 1-2 Wokingham Town

EVIDENCE A directly observed B pattern across phases C single sighting

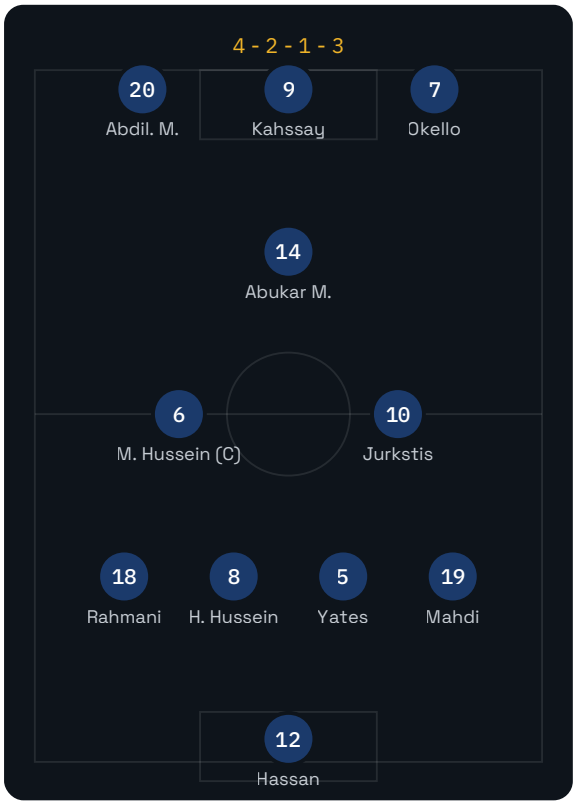
FINAL	HALF-TIME	ALL GOALS	SOURCES
1-2	0-0	65'-84'	3

Match timeline



Line-ups

Hilltop



SUBS USED #11 Micheal Kikambi, #21 Ibrahim Benabbas, #3 Mohammed Amin, #2 Mohamed Afrah

Key moments

- 59' North on for Creech WOK
- 65' Mohamed Hussein booked HIL
- 65' Moore 0-1 · press wins it in Hilltop's build-up, struck from the edge WOK
- 66' Kikambi on for Kahssay HIL
- 67' Benabbas on for Okello HIL
- 72' Peprah-Baah 0-2 · worked short corner, rebound finish WOK
- 77' Clark on for Dowding WOK
- 80' Amin on for Mohamed Hussein HIL
- 83' Bayley on for Jordan WOK
- 84' Abdilhlwahab Mohamed 1-2 · penalty, won by Rahmani HIL

Sources and How to Read the Grades

Three sources sit behind this report. The **official match record** supplies the result, lineups, scorers, card and substitution timings A. **17 minutes 29 seconds of pitch-side voice notes** across three files supply the tactical detail — structure, patterns and individual observations. An **independent match report** from the covering journalist supplies chance-by-chance narrative for the passages the audio does not cover.

Grades reflect corroboration, not confidence in the observer: A on the official record or agreed by two independent sources; B a pattern the audio records more than once; C a single sighting, or one source only.

This report covers Hilltop. Wokingham appear only where their actions explain what happened to Hilltop — principally the two goals conceded. Where the live audio and the journalist disagree, both readings are given; those divergences are set out in Source Reconciliation below, and two of them change what the game looked like.

Match Overview

Hilltop opened their Combined Counties Premier Division North season at home and lost 2-1, with all three goals arriving between the 65th and 84th minutes of a game that was goalless at the break A. Both independent accounts describe the same texture: a cagey, low-chance first half, a game decided in a seven-minute window after the hour, and a response that arrived too late A.

Hilltop set up in a 4-2-1-3 and built from a split back four with both full-backs pushed high, Mohamed Hussein (#6) dropping between or stepping up ahead of the centre-backs as the deeper of the two pivots A. The captain is recorded as the physical reference point of the side — roughly 6'4" and the tallest player on the pitch — carrying both the deepest midfield role and the set-piece duties B. That structure left recurring exposure behind it: the audio returns three separate times to a lack of recovery pace across the back line and to the space left in front of it when Hussein was slow to drop in B.

The build-up phase is where the match was lost. The audio describes Hilltop's play out from the back as short, flat and static, with players in front of the ball not making themselves available as options B, and records Rinalds Jurkstis (#10) giving the ball away on more than one occasion with body shape telegraphing the intended pass B. For an hour this went unpunished, because the audio is equally clear that Wokingham were passive out of possession — the centre-forward too slow to trigger a press, no pressing as a unit, and the explicit note that Hilltop were only able to play out because they were being allowed to B. The opening goal on 65' came from the exact opposite: a Wokingham player pressed a Hilltop player on the ball as Hilltop played out from defence, won it, and fed Sean Moore on the edge of the box A. Whether that was a half-time adjustment or a single opportunistic press is not resolvable from the material available C. Either way, the pattern Hilltop had been playing through unchallenged for an hour was the pattern that produced the goal.

The attacking threat was consistent but narrow. Abdilhlwahab Mohamed (#20) on the left produced the first chance of the match, forced two further saves from Jake Simpson across the game, and converted the penalty A. The journalist names him Hilltop's player of the match, and the audio independently flags him as quick, tricky and capable of creating his own shooting space A. The next most-repeated attacking pattern in the notes is not a forward at all but Sammim Rahmani (#18), the left-back, breaking beyond the front line — recorded on three separate occasions, and the source of the penalty B. Both of Hilltop's recurring routes ran down the left.

The pattern that did not produce. Every second-half goal kick went long and straight to Nadeer Kahssay (#9), against two centre-backs the notes describe as noticeably smaller and younger B. The return was two successful hold-ups, one duel won and one lost A. Kahssay was withdrawn on 66'.

Moment Detail

Expanding the key-moments rail on page 2, in match order.

Early first half - Chance: Abdilhlwahab Mohamed The first opening of the match. Mohamed cut inside onto his right foot from the left flank and struck a powerful effort from around 24 yards, tipped over the bar by Jake Simpson C. The audio does not capture this sequence; the live notes for this period are structural rather than event-driven.

First half - Chances conceded Two are captured in the audio: a cross that Hossam Hassan (#12) came out to contest with the striker and got a hand to, with the defence open behind him A; and a Hilltop midfield giveaway played straight to a Wokingham wide player and worked into the centre-forward, with Hassan making the save difficult A. Both accounts describe the remainder of the half as uneventful A.

59' - Wokingham substitution Registered in the audio as "new changes" at the start of the second-half file A. The observation recorded alongside it is that Hilltop had repeatedly been in a position to play in behind, and that Wokingham's offside line could have been beaten several times B.

Early second half - Chance: Mohamed Hussein A powerful effort from distance — the audio puts it at thirty yards — described as a decent strike but straight at the goalkeeper and held A. The note attached is that Hussein had been given time to set himself A.

Approx. 63' - Chance: Abdilhlwahab Mohamed A lofted pass from Jack Yates (#5) over the Wokingham right-back released Mohamed down the left side of the box A. The audio adds that he mis-controlled it initially and recovered, with his agility and first touch creating the shooting space; the near-post effort was parried by Simpson A.

65' - Yellow Card: Mohamed Hussein Cautioned in the same minute as the opening goal A. He remained on a further fifteen minutes and continued to take Hilltop's set pieces before being withdrawn on 80' A.

65' - Conceded (0-1) Wokingham pressed a Hilltop player on the ball as Hilltop played out from defence, won possession, and moved it quickly to Moore on the edge of the box, who powered it beyond Hassan A. The audio's live read of the same sequence is "a little mix-up in the defence", centrally, around twenty yards out, with the finish going to the left-hand side of the net A. Both accounts agree the goal originated in a Hilltop turnover in their own build-up rather than in a constructed Wokingham move A.

66' & 67' - Double Substitution: Kikambi for Kahssay, Benabbas for Okello Both changes are recorded within seconds of each other in the live audio, which is why the note conflates them into a single substitution A. Benabbas (#21) took up the right, with Abdilhlwahab Mohamed (#20) moving inside and Hilltop's play tilting down the left A.

72' - Conceded (0-2) A worked short-corner routine: the ball played short to Thomas Jordan, who turned past a Hilltop player on the edge of the box and lofted into the area; the close-range effort was parried by Hassan and the follow-up finished A. The live audio read the same phase as a corner "not cleared very well", headed out only as far as the edge of the area before dropping back in C — see Source Reconciliation.

80' - Substitution: Amin for Mohamed Hussein The captain, deep-lying midfielder and set-piece taker withdrawn in one change with the side two behind A. The audio contains no observation of the reorganisation that followed.

84' - Goal: Abdilhlwahab Mohamed (pen) 1-2 Won by Sammim Rahmani (#18). A one-two between Rahmani and Ibrahim Benabbas (#21) put the left-back into the penalty area in behind the Wokingham defence, where he was fouled A. The audio captures the same moment from the touchline — the left-back bursting forward again, a player who likes to get forward a lot, through into the box and caught A. Mohamed converted, sending Simpson the wrong way A.

Approx. 87' - Chance conceded A first-time forward pass released Moore in behind the Hilltop defence, one-versus-one with Hassan inside the box; the low effort was turned behind by the goalkeeper coming out C.

Late - Chance: Ibrahim Benabbas A forward pass found Mohamed on the left of the Wokingham box; he squared it to Benabbas in the centre, whose low effort under pressure went wide of the right-hand post C.

Match Phases

Phase 1: Goalless First Half (0-45 minutes)

The first-half audio is structural rather than event-driven. It opens with a full walk-through of the Hilltop shape — two centre-backs splitting, both full-backs pushing high, Mohamed Hussein (#6) stepping up in front A.

Hilltop's problems in the phase are recorded as recurring rather than isolated: giveaways from Jurkstis (#10) with telegraphed body shape B, clearances from the back described as swiped rather than struck B, and a centre-forward receiving with his back to the defender whose first touch consistently took him backwards B. The clearest chance recorded in the audio for this half fell to a Hilltop forward from a loose ball after a centre-back's touch, and the note is simply "poor finish" C.

The opposition offered little resistance to the build-up in this phase and little threat with the ball; both independent accounts converge on the same summary of the half after the opening exchanges — few chances either way A.

Phase 2: Hilltop's Best Spell (58-65 minutes)

The second-half audio opens with Hilltop creating. Hussein's thirty-yard effort was held, and the Yates-to-Mohamed sequence drew a parried save A. The long-goal-kick pattern to Kahssay runs through this window B, as does the note that Wokingham's offside line was repeatedly beatable B.

A separate note in the same window records an overload developing with no call from the full-back to organise it, and all instructions coming from the touchline rather than from the pitch A. A Hilltop corner produced static movement, with Hussein taking a front-post position without attacking the delivery C.

Phase 3: The Concession Window (65-72 minutes)

Both goals were conceded inside seven minutes, and neither came from sustained pressure A. The first came from a press on Hilltop's own build-up; the second from a rehearsed short-corner routine that created the danger outside the box rather than from the delivery A. Hilltop's double change fell between the two A. The audio's observation immediately afterwards is that urgency and aggression picked up once Hilltop went behind A.

Phase 4: The Response and an Open Finish (72-90 minutes)

An attacking free kick, won on the edge of the box, was taken from the left of the D with Hussein standing over it left-footed; the effort finished on target, low, and was gathered by Simpson going down to his side A. The penalty followed on 84' A.

The journalist records the final ten minutes as becoming a more open game, and the two remaining clear chances both fell in that window — one conceded, one created C. The audio ends before this phase; the last voice note was recorded at 21:21, around the penalty A.

Set Pieces

Attacking

Mohamed Hussein (#6) is recorded as the set-piece taker, left-footed, standing over the attacking free kick on the edge of the box in the closing phase A. Hilltop's second-half corner drew the observation of static movement in the box, with Hussein taking a front-post position without attacking the ball, the note being that he would only be effective from a flick-on C. The audio records a sequence of corners in the first half — a second and third in short succession — with no short option taken C. After Hussein's withdrawal on 80', Hilltop's remaining attacking output came through open play down the left rather than from dead balls C.

Defending

The first-half audio contains the most detailed set-piece observation in the match. Hilltop defended with man-marking plus one spare — the spare being Hussein Hussein (#8) in one instance and Jack Yates (#5) in another B. Wall construction varied between three-man and two-man across different situations B. Abdilhlwahab Mohamed (#20) is recorded as the outlet, positioned on the edge of the centre circle with everyone else back B, with one note recording approximately thirty yards between the defensive unit and that outlet C.

The 72nd-minute concession is the one that matters. It came from a defended corner in which the opposition took the delivery short: the danger was created by a turn on the edge of the box and a lofted ball into the area, against a Hilltop structure set for a delivery from the corner flag A. First contact in the box was won — Hassan parried — and the goal came from the follow-up A.

Tactical Variation and Substitutions

The changes on 66' and 67' altered the front line rather than the structure — Kikambi as the central forward and Benabbas on the right, with Mohamed shifting inside and play tilting further to the left A. Both substitutes feature in what followed: Benabbas supplied the one-two for the penalty and had the final chance of the match A.

The 80' withdrawal of Mohamed Hussein removed the captain, one half of the double pivot and the set-piece taker in a single change, with Mohammed Amin (#3) coming on A. The audio does not cover the reorganisation, and there is no record of who took over the deep midfield role or the dead balls in the closing ten minutes.

Individual Observations

Player notes recorded live, cross-checked against the two written accounts where they overlap.

Abdilhlwahab Mohamed (#20) — Left-sided, recorded as quick and tricky B. Produced the first chance of the match from a cut inside onto his right foot C, forced a parried save after Yates' lofted pass A, and converted the penalty A. Good agility and first touch to create shooting space A. Beat his man down the line and delivered a cross in the first half with nobody attacking it A. Named Hilltop's player of the match by the covering journalist A.

Mohamed Hussein (#6) — Captain and tallest player on the pitch, approximately 6'4" B. Deeper of the two pivots, stepping up from between the centre-backs in build-up A. Left-footed set-piece taker A. Long-range shooting threat, with an effort from distance held by Simpson A. Recorded as slow to drop back into the space in front of the defence B. Cautioned 65', withdrawn 80' A.

Sammim Rahmani (#18) — Left-back, and the most-repeated attacking pattern in the notes. The audio records him breaking beyond the front line on three separate occasions, including twice in the first half where the pass into the striker did not follow B. Won the penalty via a one-two with Benabbas A. Good body shape stepping out to a winger noted in the first half, though the cross still came in A.

Jibril Mahdi (#19) — Right-back A. The journalist singles out his up-and-down work on the right flank as a continuation of strong summer form C. The audio does not comment on him directly; an early transcription reading that placed a negative first-touch note against #19 has been reassigned to #9 on the basis of role — see Source Reconciliation.

Rinalds Jurkstis (#10) — Recorded giving the ball away on multiple occasions B. Body shape noted as telegraphing his intended pass B. One sequence records him receiving in midfield, attempting to play out to the right with two defenders in the way, with the pass described as awful A. A separate note records a decision made with time on the ball that did not need to be rushed C.

Nadeer Kahssay (#9) — Target for every long goal kick in the second half B. Held it up successfully twice, won one, lost one A. Matched against two smaller, younger centre-backs A. Recorded receiving with his back to the defender, with a first touch that consistently took him backwards B. Withdrawn 66' A.

Jack Yates (#5) — Right centre-back A. Played the lofted diagonal over the Wokingham right-back that created the parried chance A. Named as the spare man in one defensive set-piece structure C.

Hussein Hussein (#8) — Left centre-back, described as very slight A. Recorded taking a heavy touch under no immediate pressure, being closed down and dispossessed A. Named as the spare man in a second set-piece structure C.

Hossam Hassan (#12) — Came out to contest a first-half cross and got a hand to it, with the defence open behind A. Made a save into his body immediately before the opening goal A. Parried the close-range effort that led to the second A. Turned a one-on-one behind late on C. Described in the audio as very young C.

Ibrahim Benabbas (#21) — On 67' to the right A. Supplied the one-two for the penalty A and had Hilltop's final chance, low and wide of the right-hand post under pressure C.

Micheal Kikambi (#11) — On 66' as the central forward A. The audio records a #11 as lively with a couple of shots in the closing period C; neither written account corroborates this, and the number is not independently confirmed.

Abukar Mohamed (#14) — Recorded making forward runs beyond the ball, including one past a teammate that worked well but left ground to recover B. Noted as quick C.

Source Reconciliation

Four points where the live audio and the written accounts diverge. Each is recorded here rather than resolved silently.

1. Who won the penalty. The live note describes a player "bursting forward again, likes to get forward a lot", through into the box and fouled, and the transcript renders the number as 11. The journalist identifies the player as Sammim Rahmani (#18), the left-back, after a one-two with Benabbas. The journalist's account is adopted: it matches the audio's own description of a full-back breaking forward, matches the first-half pattern of Rahmani doing exactly that twice, and 18/11 is a documented failure mode of the transcription on this audio. An earlier draft attributed this to Kikambi (#11); that attribution was wrong.

2. How the second goal was built. The live note reads it as a corner "not cleared very well". The journalist describes a deliberate short-corner routine — played short, a turn on the edge of the box, a lofted delivery. These are not the same event description. The journalist's version is adopted as the build-up, with the audio's read retained for the finish, where a parried effort and a scrambled follow-up is consistent with what "not cleared very well" would look like from the touchline. The distinction matters: a rehearsed routine that pulls the danger outside the box is a different defensive problem from a failure to clear.

3. The opposition press. The first-half audio is unambiguous that Wokingham did not press. The opening goal came from a press. Both can be true — the audio covers roughly the first twelve minutes of the half in detail and almost nothing between then and 58'. There is no material available to establish whether this was a half-time adjustment or an isolated event, and it is left open.

4. The negative first-touch note. The transcript renders "the ball goes in for number 19, he's only ever got his back to the defender, his first touch is always taking him backwards". The described role is a centre-forward receiving to feet with his back to goal, which is Kahssay (#9), not Mahdi (#19) at right-back; the journalist independently praises Mahdi's performance. The note has been reassigned to #9, where it also matches the separate hold-up-play observations. 9/19 is a documented failure mode of the transcription on this audio.

Data Quality Note

The audio is the limiting factor on everything tactical in this report. It was recorded at roughly -36 dBFS with continuous wind and crowd noise, consistent with a phone in a pocket rather than held or clipped. Recovery required gain normalisation and high-pass filtering, then two independent Whisper passes (large-v3 and turbo) merged window-by-window because each recovered speech the other lost. Passages where both passes failed are absent from this report rather than guessed at.

Three limitations apply. First, coverage: 17 minutes 29 seconds of notes across a 90-minute match, weighted towards the opening of the first half and the closing half-hour. The period between roughly 12' and 58' is almost entirely unobserved, which is why the first-half narrative here is structural rather than chronological. Second, spoken shirt numbers are the least reliable element of the transcript — 8/18, 9/19, 11/14 and 20/2 are all confused by the transcription on this audio, and two of the four reconciliations above are number errors. Every number spoken does resolve to a real player in the squad, and the 66'/67' double substitution the audio conflated into one was independently confirmed,

which is the basis of the roster check passing; but individual numbers carry no independent weight without corroboration. Third, the audio carries no minute markers, so phase timings are anchored to the goal and substitution events the notes describe rather than measured.

The 4-2-1-3 and its positional assignments are the club's own shape as confirmed by the coach, and the audio walk-through is consistent with it A.